

one of the greatest of all time. Or perhaps it's the amazing voice acting, well actually, it's all the narrator. He breathes life into this game, he gives the game a voice, and the game lives and dies by his words.

The atmosphere, the narration, the world, everything in Bastion is an unforgettable experience. You play as "The Kid", who wields two different kinds of weapons, one melee, one ranged. It's all fluid and smooth but it's not the game-play that will keep you playing.

Super Meat Boy

Super Meat Boy has you playing as a raw piece of meat. 10/10 for creativity. But will playing as a piece of meat be fun? Hell yes!

Super Meat Boy is a ridiculously tough, rage inducing, controller-smashing, super frustrating, fast paced 2D platformer that's unforgiving and we absolutely love it for that.

It's a game that's inspired by classics like Mega Man and Ghosts 'n Goblins and was designed to bring back the nostalgic feel of playing those old-school Nintendo games. Just in case we haven't mentioned, this game is insanely tough. It's almost like beating a boss on Dark Souls (almost because Super Meat Boy is tougher).

Braid

Braid is what we'd like to call a platformer masterpiece. It's so good we could say that it sets the standard for every puzzle platformer that will follow. It features a beautiful hand-painted art style

and draws inspiration from age old classics like Prince of Persia and Mario where your goal is to save the – you guessed it – princess.

In Braid, you take on the role of Tim, who makes use of a time manipulation mechanic which boggles the mind and has you using brain muscles that you didn't know you had. The story is enthralling, something that is quite rare in a sidescroller platformer game. As you progress through the game and find hidden passageways, you learn more about Tim and the story. This is one game that keeps you guessing and where you want to progress and find out more. But you're never quite given a straight answer. It's open to interpretation and whatever conclusion you decide to come to when you finish this game, it still feels very satisfying when you manage to get your hands on every last puzzle piece.

Minecraft

Shoe-string budget? Check. Tiny development team? Check. Over 5 million copies sold? Check. Over 70 million in sales? Check. 2.5 billion dollar buyout? No problem. Need we say more?

Minecraft is a game that blew up in 2011, which first came out for PC and later for the Xbox. You would actually need to have been living under some

rock in some cave to never have heard about this game. It's THAT famous.

Minecraft's heart and soul is it's crafting system. So simple but yet so complex. You start with nothing. No items, no weapons, and absolutely no clue as to what you're doing. You can run around, punch stuff and enjoy the pixelated landscapes, that's about it. But then you learn how the game works, as you learn to gather materials, learn to craft, learn to make tools and improve them, and learn about the horrors of the night, learn ab-- we're already addicted, damnit!

What's in store for the future of Indies?

The games we just mentioned are few of the many amazing indie games out there that definitely deserve our attention. These are games that are remoulding and reshaping the very genres they belong to. They've given us some of the most innovative and unique experiences we've had on any gaming platform. As the digital market grows exponentially, so does the market for independently developed games. We would have mentioned several more if we didn't have any space restrictions. The Indie Movement is only just beginning, we're yet to see the peak of the Indie Era and we're sure there will be many more indie gems to come. Thanks to things like crowdfunding, more people are actually able to pitch their ideas to the masses and get things moving. Furthermore, two of the most popular engines used in games – Unreal Engine and Unity – are free for use for developers. Game engines are normally quite pricey, so this was also great news for indie devs. People are showing great interest in indie projects. These guys actually listen to what the gamers want and so we're more than happy to help these guys create a great game for us. Real talk though, at the end of the day, we don't really care where a good game comes from, but when an indie title draws much more attention than all the Call of Duty's, Battlefield's, and FIFA's, maybe the AAA guys have been doing something wrong all this while? *

